

Regular Meeting

Monday, October 1, 2018

Medford School Committee

Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the Council Chamber at 7:04 PM. Those present were: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell and Assistant Superintendent of Finance Kirsteen Patterson. In addition Mayor Burke noted the attendance of the MHS Representative Jasper Su.

Mayor – Ms. Kreatz call the roll – All in attendance

Roll call - 7-0

Approval of the Minutes of September 17, 2018 - Motion to approve by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto – all in favor, those opposed - motion passes

Approval of bills/transfer of funds – Question by Ms. DiBenedetto of a bill in operations/maintenance? Ms. Patterson – It's the Columbus slide. Motion to approve. Ms. Kreatz – It's not installed yet. Issue with screws. When completed John McLaughlin will notify School Committee. Question by Mr. Ruggiero regarding textbooks? Ms. Patterson – Whatever textbooks are needed, we will purchase. On the motion for approval by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote – 7-0 motion passes

Approval of payrolls – Questions by Ms. DiBenedetto regarding the complete audit & the full payroll? Ms. Patterson – Right now you are seeing new hires/resignations only. There is too much documentation for every 2 weeks. Ms. DiBenedetto – But what about twice a year? Mayor Burke - Audit is in process. Ms. DiBenedetto – So possibly in January? Ms. Patterson – Please keep in mind that many contracts aren't finished so those items that are forthcoming / not reflected in budget/payroll. On the motion for approval by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz

Roll call vote – 7-0 motion passes

Report of Secretary – Ms. Kreatz distributed her report to everyone – She reported that she visited all elementary school/playgrounds over summer. She also reported that she volunteered to read to all K at all the elementary. In addition, she attended the MHS/MVTHS Parent Information Night. She advocated for the students in cosmetology, that the general public would

contact them so they can work on customers. Ms. Kreatez continued wanting to know when the PTO registration form will be available online and transferred to schools for ownership. She also reported that she had distributed Elks Scholarship applications to schools, and school committee doesn't need to approve. Motion to approve and place Secretary Report on file by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion carries.

Mr. Ruggiero – requests to suspend the rules

Mr. Ken Krause – 50 Mystic St/Friends of Chevalier – Discussed special event at Chevalier next Wed/Oct 10th at 7 PM, Free Admission. A Talk by Bill Cummings, moderated by former Mayor Michael J. McGlynn. Mr. Cummings will discuss his new book: Starting Small & Making it Big. Part of the Arts Across Medford Program. The Cummings Foundation supports CCSR with a \$100,000 to that program. Mayor Burke – CCSR was handing out flyers for people to attend. Thank you Mr. Krause.

Report from Superintendent- Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent discussed the (4) math learning walks at all the elementary schools. Between 10-12 people participated, over two different days, to gather baseline data. The group included: Math Coaches, Grace Basile & Ellie O'Leary, Math Coordinator Faiza Khan, Director of Curriculum & Instruction Bernadette Ricciardelli, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Principals Suzanne Galusi, Kirk Johnson, Diane Guarino & Kathy Kay, Assistant Principals Andrew O'Brien, Doreen Andrews and Shannon Demos, Our Lesley University Partners: Dr. Patricia Crain de Galarce, Sue Cusak & Christina Jache, and myself. Our Director of Public Relations, Lisa Evangelista also attended, and documented the work. It was wonderful to take this time to observe Medford education in action. 48 classrooms were observed. We looked for students to be challenged. We noted what academic vocabulary was being used. We also noted access for all, accommodations for all learners, and all students being given feedback. At our next meeting I will present a complete report.

Dr. Vincent noted that there was an isolated medical incident at Medford High School. The Mayor and School Committee were informed and all protocols followed

Dr. Vincent also met with the Middle School Principals and visited some of the classrooms there. It is my plan to do more of that.

Dr. Vincent attended District Attorney Marian Ryan's Annual Breakfast for Superintendents, Police Chiefs and Fire Chiefs, where the opiate crisis was discussed.

Dr. Vincent was interviewed by the MVTHS Media Tech students. That interview is on the MPS Blog at mpsadvantage.education

Mayor Burke – Thank Dr. Vincent

Report on New MCAS Accountability System – Dr. Vincent – I’d like to welcome Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli, Director of Curriculum & Instruction and Headmaster Paul D’Alleva to the podium now to discuss the new accountability System. Dr.. Ricciardelli – This power point presentation is also in your packet and is meant as an overview of the new accountability system. The focus is on raising the performance of each school’s lowest performing students

Mr. D’Alleva - This new system discontinues the levels 1-5 to measure a school’s progress. Dr. Ricciardelli – So by way of history. ESSA passed by Federal Government in Dec 2015. In June 2018 – Massachusetts plan is approved by Board of Education. Tonight you see the new accountability ratings. Mr. D’Alleva - ESSA requires academic achievement based on annual assessments in English language arts, math & science and also looks at graduation rates and English proficiency for EL. There is one measure of quality for achievement and student growth. The EL proficiency access scores never added in, now they are. Additional indicators – chronic absenteeism now counts. In High School, EL proficiency now a part along with absenteeism, advanced placement and who succeeds in those courses. Our new indicator is the 2017 baseline data. State determines criteria and sets achievement targets for each school in a district. Ms. Van der Kloot – When discussing chronic absenteeism...what about students in crisis? How do they account for that type of absence? Mr. D’Alleva - An absence is still an absence whether excused or no. But home instruction for medical is still considered IN SCHOOL, just have to code it appropriately. However extended medical is still considered an absence. We would have to get to that student to somehow re-engage that student, as chronic absenteeism hit us hard. Ms. DiBenedetto – Now we can pay attention to those absences to identify it & be on top of it. Mr. D’Alleva - State is tracking more students than ever before. Comparing all students to the lowest performing students and take average. Separate comparison categories will not be necessary once all grades move to Next Generation MCAS. Department of Education now has access to every course that every student takes. We will now know in advance which students are in lowest performing category. Dr. Ricciardelli - 85% of all schools in the State are considered partially meeting target category. Medford falls into that category. Mr. D’Alleva - Change is less punitive and more supportive now, school focused accountability. Mr. Ruggiero – We get the report card at end of year – but nothing in between - a prelim MCAS score would be great. Mayor Burke – When a student comes to us from another district, do we see their academic past? Mr. D’Alleva – We can go in and look at a student’s MCAS from other district. Mayor Burke – Are 5th grade looked at middle school data? Mr. D’Alleva – Yes. Ms. Van der Kloot – What about transient students? Mr. D’Alleva –If not with us for 2 years, they don’t count, for lowest performing. Dr. Ricciardelli - Tomorrow night might provide more information.

On the motion to accept the report by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Before/After School – Megan Fidler- Carey – worked in Revere prior. Asked School Committee for their support. Ms. Carey’s intentions are to increase communication between teachers and school staff. Ms. Carey we provide gym time, social emotional and have fun and keep children safe. Both programs have increased 30% in past 2 years. We are looking for quality people to hire, and we are hiring as fast as we can. We are not a babysitting service. For example, at the McGlynn we have done walking field trips, to teach them how to go to the grocery store, or how to take the bus. We are proud to provide real world experiences. My job is set expectations for my staff. Staff development is important. Some kids are 5 days vs 2 days ...numbers don’t break that out –there is more interest in 5 days. Ms. DiBenedetto - Every family needs to be aware and put on wait lists if necessary. Also, could the district offer free CPR and free fingerprinting? Then we can entice more people to apply. Ms. Van der Kloot - Before we vote... what is the cost? Ms. Patterson – Fingerprinting cost = \$35 pp. Please note fingerprinting is mandated by law and is a condition of employment. In addition, if you waive the cost for (1) group of employees, you will have the request from other personnel in the district. It’s something we haven’t budgeted for. Free fingerprinting is taken off the table. Ms. Carey – We are a self- sustaining program. We accept vouchers from the State and receive CDBG funding. Ms. DiBenedetto – Is wait list a space issue or staff issue? Ms. Carey – Staff issue. I will work on the space limitations. With your support, we should be overstaffing. We don’t have extras in case of anything. We can hire creatively to have more concentrated staffing and we want to do strategic planning.

Motion on floor by Mr. Ruggiero and seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to look into ways to provide free CPR training – All in favor, Motion passes.

Report on New Superintendent Induction Program – Dr. Vincent – We welcome my mentor, Dr. Karla Baehr. There are (40) new Superintendents in Massachusetts. The New Superintendent Induction Program works in a partnership with the Department of Education, the Massachusetts School Superintendents Association, and the Massachusetts Association of School Committees. Dr. Baehr – The new Superintendent’s program is a (3) year program to support new Superintendent. My role is to help manage the Superintendent as they learn their new role. Dr. Vincent will submit a report to you in January and I will periodically attend School Committee meetings. My role is also to support Dr. Vincent and to assist her in moving her goals forward. I also will assist her as she develops strategy for you the School Committee and the school district. My intention is to help Dr. Vincent turn her findings into a robust strategy. The most important thing that I can do, is keep Dr. Vincent focused on instruction and learning, amongst the other things they have to address. Ms. Van der Kloot – The School Committee’s role is to assess the new Superintendent. How will we go about that with a new person in the role? Dr. Baehr – Our content days will provide goals to School Committee of which Superintendent will be assessed. The goals of the program will be to learn and grow with each other, so that the Superintendent is able to drive the goals of their district. Mayor Burke – Do all the Superintendents have similar

issues? Dr. Baehr – They all have to learn how to work with their School Committees and that their community has been heard. They all have to develop strategies. They have to learn how to say no, a lot, as much as they'd like to say yes. No one has enough money. There are challenging students in every district. Today, there is a lot of public discourse as well.

Motion to accept this report and place on file by Ms. Van der Kloot and seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Motion passes.

Update on FOSS Next Generation program – Mr. Rocco Cieri – as you are aware we conducted a pilot of this and intend to roll it out next year. Each unit takes 3-4 months to teach. If we are to adopt the program the costs are included in your packets. Mr. Ruseau – This is great information. Is it based on a classroom set? Mr. Cieri – Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto – Is this program available for special education and EL? Mr. Cieri – Yes in upper grades. Please note it was originally designed for students with disabilities. It is a defining characteristic of program – For EL – it's a language sporting program – it's extremely well designed for science learning, continually researched and refined. Ms. Mustone - Shouldn't we just make a motion to buy this program? We've been discussing it for 2 years. McGraw Hill is what my 4th grader is being taught from now. Mr. Cieri – I'm comfortable with this program – it's a strong program – we can accelerate in 3-4 months. Mr. Ruggiero – Could we see the kits? Mr. Cieri – Seeing a few of the trainings is probably better. There is one on Oct 17th – grade 4 at Columbus. Please note, you can't mix and match units. Ms. Van der Kloot - I understand the urgency from Ms. Mustone – is there any way we could accelerate to adopt in the spring time? Mr. Cieri - I will ask the vendor. Dr. Vincent - I do truly support FOSS program, but price tag is very costly – to accelerate to adopt in Jan? So is it half the cost? To do entire district at this point, it's over \$100,000 that has not been budgeted for – we'd still have to repurchase it next year due to live organisms. Mayor Burke – We can discuss as a group and decide. Ms. DiBenedetto – I'd like to make a motion for Superintendent to purchase for teachers so we can have training start in Spring. Dr. Vincent – We will need to negotiate with teacher union and company.

Motion to receive the report and place on file. Motion carries.

Report on Enrollment Numbers – Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell – The first couple of weeks of school, a number of students are enrolled, but do not end up attending. So we have unenrolled them. EL students continue to come into the district as well as for Pre K. Ms. Van der Kloot – This report shows clearer numbers. I would like to report that some families who were not successful in their lottery choice and received the McGlynn Middle and were upset at the time. Now they couldn't be happier. Ms. Caldwell - We love to hear that! The teachers are very good as is the leadership at the McGlynn. Ms. DiBenedetto – How do we check on the home schooled students in the district? Ms. Ricciardelli – We are in the process of reviewing the parent plans. I will get the numbers and get back to you. Ms. Mustone – What about our chronic

absenteeism? (20) out in McGlynn on one day? Ms. Caldwell – We are now watching these students, to see what's going on. Mr. Ruseau – Pre K and K absences are not counted towards our totals.

Motion to accept this report and place on file by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot ,
Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve & Accept Krystle Campbell Memorial Gift Agreement – Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson – I am recommending that the Medford Public Schools and CCSR are able to accept this generous agreement. Mayor Burke – We are indebted to Krystle's family and friends for raising this money, which will enable her legacy to live on. Our Commissioner of Trust Funds will oversee this gift. Ms. Van der Kloot – Please have a letter of thanks sent on our behalf.

Motion to accept this gift by Ms. DiBenedetto, - by Ms. Mustone. Roll Call Vote – 7-0 motion passes

School Committee Resolutions – Mayor Burke – Speaking on former School Committee Member George White, stated what a joy it was to have George around. His loss is big one for this community. He had a big impact on me. Ms. Van der Kloot – I served with him both on the School Committee and the Building the Future Committee. George was an active member and so much fun. Mayor Burke – I am recommending that something be dedicated to his memory.

Ms. DiBenedetto – I am requesting the following reports

- Status of the PTO Registration Form and who in the district will be responsible for that
- The status of Ms. DiGiantammo's plaque dedication
- The status of the Safety Report
- Is there a disability awareness program ? Maybe the Special Education subcommittee can address? Or maybe Lesley University can offer this type of programming?
- Status of January payroll update – Just wanted to remind you
- What are our home school numbers?.

Motion to adjourn 9:39 PM, motion passes

